Ans : (a) Neyyar, Peppara and Shendurney Wildlife Sanctuaries: and Kalakad Mundanthura Tiger Reserve are in Agasthyamala Biosphere reserve. It is located in the western Ghats in south India. Consisting mostly of tropical forest, the site is home to 2, 254 species of higher plants including about 400 that are endemic. It is also a unique genetic reservoir of cultivated plants, in particular cardamom, jamun, nutmeg, pepper and plantain.

84. Consider the following statements :
1. Some species of turtles are herbivores
2. Some species of fish are herbivores.
3. Some species of marine mammals
4. Some species of snakes are viviparous.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (d) Green sea turtles eat, sea grasses and algae, though juveniles snack on crabs, sponges, and jellyfish. In the wild, they can live up to 80 years and grow up to 5 feet long. Once mature, it is the only sea turtle that is strictly herbivorous.
Statement (1) is correct
Parrotfish are algae eaters. They obtain the algae by ripping small chunks of coral from a reef. Many other herbivores thrive among the fish population. Other herbivores include the Japanese angelfish, yellow blotch rabbit fish and tilapia. Statement (2) in correct.
The diet of Manatees consists of water, grasses, weeds and algae. Dugongs are related to manatees, which are both endangered and protected animals. Their slow-moving herbivores graze on underwater grasses, rooting them out with bristled, sensitive snouts and chomping them with rough lips statement (3) is correct.
Snakes that are viviparous no wish their developing young through a placenta and yolk sac, something that is highly unusual among reptiles. Boa constrictors and green anacondas are two examples of viviparous snakes, meaning they give birth to live young with no eggs involved at any stage of development. Statement (4) is correct.

85. Consider the following pairs
Wildife Naturally found in
1. Blue-finned Mahseer : Cauvery River
2. Irrawaddy Dolphin : Chambal River
3. Rusty-spotted Cat : Eastern Chats
Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (c) Blue- finned Mahseer is found naturally in the Cauvery River.
The Irrawaddy dolphin is a critically endangered species. It is found near sea coasts and in estuaries and rivers in parts of the Bay of Bengal and southeast Asia. In India, it is found in lake Chilika and not the Chambal river. The genetic dolphin is found in the Chambal river.
Rusty spotted cat is one of the world's smallest feline. The rusty spotted cat, one of the few wild cats that inhabit the forests of Andhra Pradesh, is among the animals in the Eastern Ghats.

86. Consider the following statements :
The Environment Protection Act, 1986 empowers the Government of India to
1. state the requirement of public participation in the process of environmental protection, and the procedure and manner in which it is sought
2. lay down the standards for emission or discharge of environmental pollutants from various sources
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (c) The Environment impact assessment notification was made by the Government of India in pursuance of the powers conferred on it by the Environment Protection Act [sub -section (1) and clause (v) of sub-section (2) of section (3) of the Environment (protection) Act -1986] one of the most significant determinants of EIA is the procedure of public Hearing and Public participation on any developmental project. therefore statement (1) is correct.
As per section 3 of the EPA the Government of India is empowered to make rules in laying down standards for emission or discharge of environmental pollutants from various sources. Therefore, Statement (2) is correct.

87. Consider the following :
1. Carbon monoxide 2. Methane
3. Ozone 4. Sulphur dioxide
Which of the above are released into atmosphere due to the burning of crop/biomass residue?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (d) Combustion of Crop/biomass result in the release of pollutants such as carbon monoxide, methane, carbon dioxide, nitrous oxide, sulphur dioxide, ozone, lead, mercury and particulate matter into the atmosphere. According to a report, only Haryana and Punjab contribute 48% of the pollutants generated due to burning of crops.
At present, the problem of air pollution is increasing due to the burning of crop residue (parali)

88. Why is there a great concern about the 'microbeads' that are released into environment?
(a) They are considered harmful to marine ecosystems.
(b) They are considered to cause skin cancer in children.
(c) They are small enough to be absorbed by crop plants in irrigated fields.
(d) They are often found to be used as food adulterants.

Ans : (a) Microbeads are manufactured solid plastic particles of less than one millimeter in their largest dimension. They are most frequently made of polyethylene but can be made of other petrochemical plastics such as polypropylene and polystyrene. They are used in exfoliating personnel care products toothpaste and in biomedical science research.
Microbeads can cause plastic particle water pollution and pose an environmental hazard for aquatic animals in freshwater and ocean water.

CURRENT AFFAIRS

89. Atal Innovation Mission is set up under the
(a) Department of Science and Technology
(b) Ministry of Labour and Employment
(c) NITI Aayog
(d) Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

Ans : (c) The Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) is a flag ship initiative initiated by the NITI AYOG. Atal Innovation mission (AIM) including self-Employment and Talent Utilization (SETU) is Government of India's endeavor to promote a culture of innovation and entrepreneurship. Its objective is to serve as a platform for promotion of world-class Innovation Hubs, Grand Challenges, start-up Businesses and other self-employment activities. particularity in technology driven areas.

90. The Global Competitiveness Report is published by the
(a) International Monetary Fund
(b) United Nations Conference on Trade and Development
(c) World Economic Forum
(d) World Bank

Ans : (c) The Global Competitiveness Report is a yearly report published by the World Economic Forum. Since, 2004, the Global Competitiveness Index developed by Xavier salt-i-Martin and Elsa V Artadi. Its headquarter is located in Geneva. The report has twelve pillars of competitiveness. India has been ranked at 68th position while Singapore topped the Index in 2019.

91. Recently, India signed a deal known as 'Action Plan for Prioritization and Implementation of Cooperation Areas in the Nuclear Field' with which of the following countries?
(a) Japan
(b) Russia
(c) The United Kingdom
(d) The United States of America

Ans : (b) India and Russia on 5 October, inked an action plan for expanding civil nuclear partnership comprising second site for Russian nuclear reactors in India. The two countries intend to develop a project of six nuclear power unit of Russian design at a new site in India, further enhance cooperation in third countries and bring in new perspective nuclear technologies together with joint construction of nuclear power plants. For the new nuclear project in India Russia will offer the evolutionary VVER generation "3+" technical solutions and will increase the level of Indian industry's involvement and localization.

92. Consider the following statements :
1. The United Nations Convention against Corruption (UNCAC) has a 'Protocol against the Smuggling of Migrants by Land, Sea and Air'.
2. The UNCAC is the ever-first legally binding global anti-corruption instrument.
3. A highlight of the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organized Crime (UNTOC) is the inclusion of a specific chapter aimed at returning assets to their rightful owners from whom they had been taken illicitly.
4. The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) is mandated by its member States to assist in the implementation of both UNCAC and UNTOC.
Which of the statements given above are correct
(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (c) UNCAC is the first legally binding universal anti-corruption instrument. The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) is mandated by UN member states to cooperate in the implementation of both UNCAC and UNTOC.

93. As per the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016 in India, Which one of the following statements in correct?
(a) Waste generator has to segregate waste into five categories.
(b) The Rules are applicable to notified urban local bodies, notified towns and all industrial townships only.
(c) The Rules provide for exact and elaborate criteria for the identification of sites for landfills and waste processing facilities.
(d) It is mandatory on the part of waste generator that the waste generated in one district cannot be moved to another district.

Ans : (c) The solid waste management rules 2016 provide for detailed criteria for setting-up solid waste processing and treatment facility, solid waste management in hilly areas for waste to energy process, for sanitary, landfills, for site selection, development of facilities for the sanitary landfills, specifications for land filling operation and closure on completion of landfilling, pollution prevention, closure and Rehabilitation of old dumps etc.
The SWM rules will also apply outside the municipal areas. The rules will now also include city-related groups census towns, notified industrial townships, area controlled by Indian Railways, airport, ports, defence establishments, special economic zones, originations of centre and states pilgrimage sites and places of religious and historical importance are also included.

94. Consider the following statements :
As per the Industrial Employment (Standing Orders) Central (Amendment) Rules, 2018
1. if rules for fixed-term employment are implemented, it becomes easier for the firms/companies to lay off workers.
2. no notice of termination of employment shall be necessary in the case of temporary workman.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (c) The Government has notified fixed term employment for all sections through an amendment to the Industrial Employment (standing orders) central rules, 1946, fixed them employment for all sectors will make it easier for companies to hire-and-fire work along with reducing the role of middlemen statement (1) is correct
No notice of termination of employment shall be necessary in the case of temporary workman whether monthly rated weekly rated or piece rated are probationers or badli workmen. Statement (2) is correct.

95. What was the purpose of Inter-Creditor Agreement signed by Indian banks and financial institutions recently?
(a) To lessen the Government of India's perennial burden of fiscal deficit and current account deficit.
(b) To support the infrastructure projects of Central and State Governments.